DEPARTMENT OF curriculum +instruction

# Elementary education

## Timing

1. You should discuss the written preliminary exam with your advisor as you near completion of your coursework
2. You will have 1 month/question (2 questions)
3. The committee member who assigned the question reads the exam and informs you and your adviser of the outcome within 2-3 weeks
4. When you pass your written exam questions, you should schedule a two-hour meeting for the oral exam by contacting all committee members and arranging for a room (through graduate studies). We encourage you to schedule the Orals as soon as possible after all written exam questions have been passed.

| **Written Exam** | **Oral Exam** |
|---|---|
| Although you will draw on knowledge gained from your program of study, both the written and oral prelim exams are designed to be forward looking. You will be assessed on your ability to draw on theories, ideas, methodologies, and concepts; clearly and cogently make arguments; and explore the limits of these ideas. | |
| The exam consists of two take home papers that you will write independently. The topics and length are negotiated with the committee member for whom you are writing (with typical length being 20-25 pages, excluding references). You are responsible for asking faculty members to serve on your committee.<br><br>The possible results are *Pass* (No revisions); *Revisions Required* (must address the comments); or *Fail* (Did not pass, cannot revise, must re-take).<br><br>If you fail an exam question, the committee member should give general remarks about why you failed the exam question and offer the option of a second chance to respond.<br><br>The length of time allowed for the re-write is stipulated by the committee member.<br><br>If you fail one or both of the exam questions on the second chance, you will be counseled out of the program. | Focuses primarily on written prelim questions. Because the written prelims are forward looking (theoretically and methodologically) the oral prelim will include conceptual discussion of the dissertation topic. |